FARSHORE

The Odyssey: Arcade Trials

Phase 2: Interface structure and AI interaction design



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The five arcade trials

Each shore uses different controls and shows an active rival

Shore	Player interaction	Visible rival action
Cyclops	Grid stealth	Blind smash from noise clues
Circe	Falling-potion match-3	Own board, chains and curses
Sirens	Four-lane melody memory	Composes and targets missed lanes
Scylla & Charybdis	Shield paddle and rowing	Six heads with pulsing vortex
Ithaca	Turn-based archery	Own scored shot or ring block

Players and design needs

Phase 1 persona sketches guide the flows

Maya, 21

Win through skill and understand why the rival behaves differently.

Fixed rules and visible rival warnings.

Daniel, 19

Experience the Odyssey without a confusing first encounter.

Short practice and one clear objective per shore.

Rosa, 34

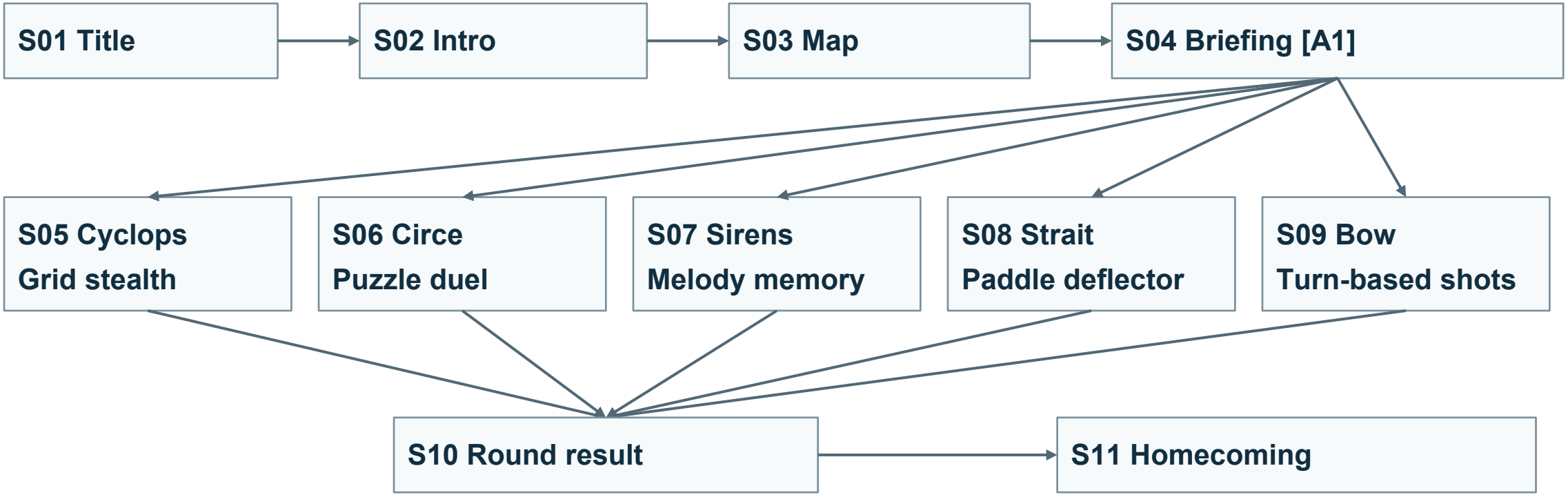
Know what the model changes and keep control over its result.

Model labels, strategy review and a usable fallback.

Provisional design references. Interview evidence has not been supplied.

Screen hierarchy

A1 in the briefing is the only pretrained-model feature

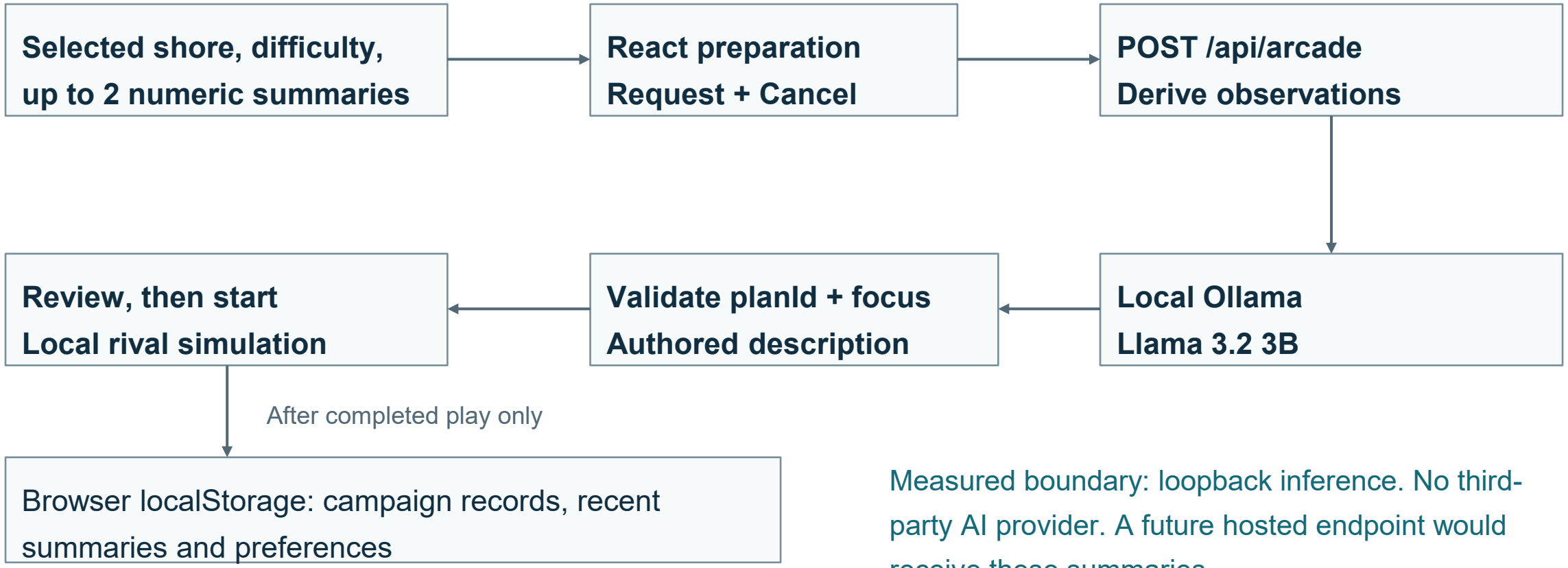


Clear or assist returns to Map for the next shore. The fifth passage opens Homecoming.

Shared overlays: S12 Settings, S13 Pause/leave, S14 Restart, S15 Assisted passage

Model data flow and privacy

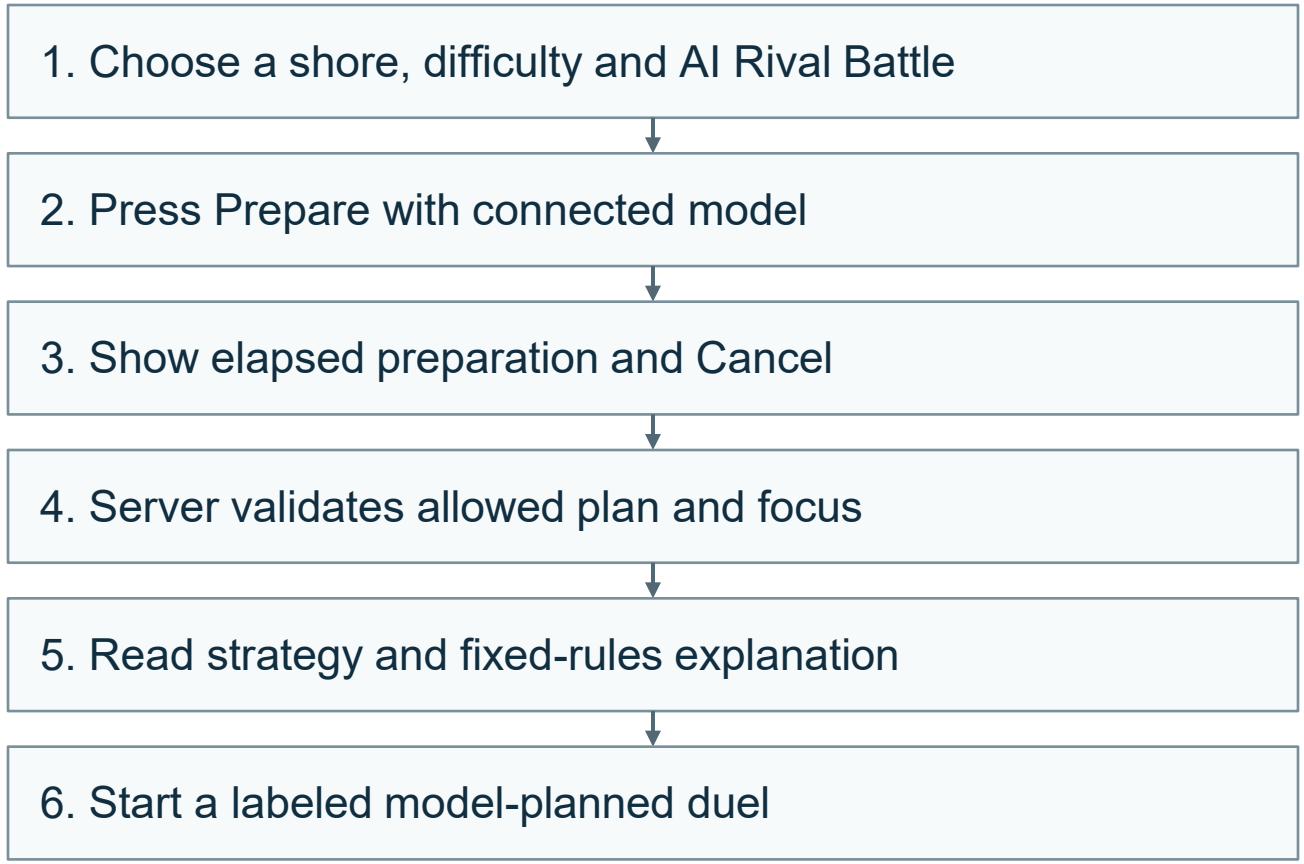
Numeric summaries prepare a strategy before the round



Measured boundary: loopback inference. No third-party AI provider. A future hosted endpoint would receive these summaries.

F2: Strategy preparation and review

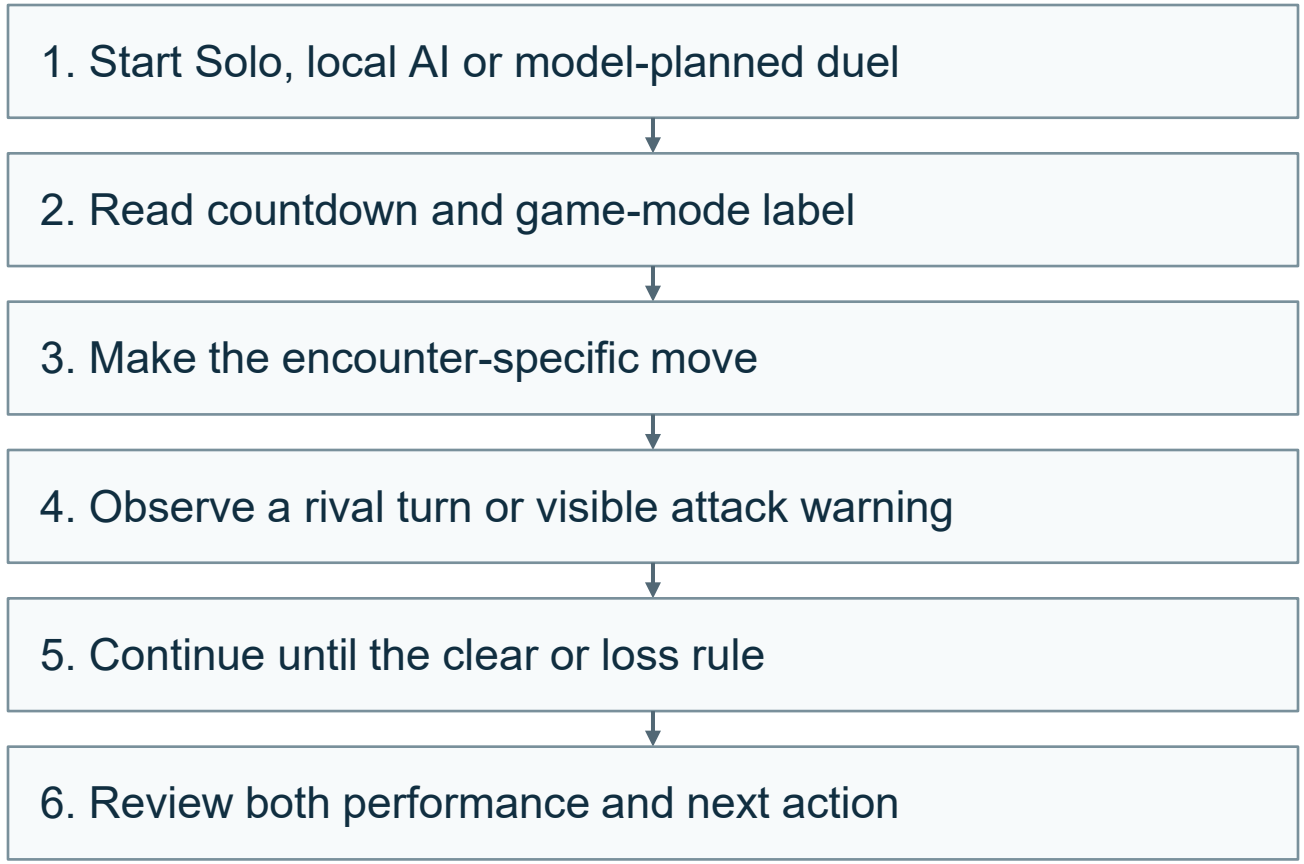
Maya and Rosa / player control before a match



- Cancel preserves progress.
- Prepare another replaces the candidate.
- Edit difficulty or choose Solo to discard.
- Proposed: a dedicated Discard action.

F3: Active play and recovery

Maya and Daniel / local simulation keeps play responsive



- Warnings show what the rival will do.
- Pause stops clocks and held controls.
- Loss offers retry or short practice.
- Assistance has an honest report label.

AI preparation states

Initial, loading and reviewed success

Initial

- Difficulty and mode
- Local rival ready
- Prepare with model

Loading

- Preparing strategy
- 12 seconds elapsed
- Cancel / Practice

Success

- Chain Alchemist
- Fixed Normal rules
- Start / Prepare another

W05-W07 / F2. Preparation consumes no gameplay time.

F4: Uncertainty and error recovery

Rosa and Maya / no dead end and no invented confidence score

Uncertain or unsupported

- Unsupported strategy
- Nothing changed
- Retry / local AI / Solo

Service error

- Unavailable or timed out
- Your voyage is kept
- Retry / check / local play

W08-W09 / F4. Invalid input is rejected before model contact.

AI technical spike

Six real calls to local Llama 3.2 3B

Min 7.317s Mean 8.278s Max 11.613s

Sample	Seconds	Selected plan	Review
S1 First-time Cyclops	11.613	focused/center	Legal, advisory mismatch
S2 Circe after two losses	7.597	chain/balanced	Matches loss preference
S3 Sirens with red-lane misses	7.317	echo/balanced	Legal, local lane targeting
S4 Strait after one hull loss	7.889	pincer/balanced	Legal, advisory mismatch
S5 Archery after low ring score	7.614	feint/balanced	Legal block-shot policy
S6 Cyclops with left-side habit	7.641	focused/left	Required left focus kept

Six legal outputs. One sequential sample; tactical quality still needs evaluation.

Failure evidence and design decisions

Real provider failures, with app validation kept separate

Triggered condition	Observed response	UI response
Nonexistent provider model	HTTP 404, model not found	Check / retry / local play
Malformed provider JSON	HTTP 400, unexpected EOF	Explain failure / retain selections
Unsupported difficulty	App HTTP 400 before inference	Supported-choice guidance

Wait design: elapsed time and Cancel, with every round clock stopped.

No live 429 or capacity benchmark. Local API calls had no billed fee.

Hardware, electricity and future hosting costs are unmeasured.

Phase 2 design and next evaluation

Implemented behavior and proposed improvements

Implemented

- Five distinct playable trials
- Model review, cancellation and regeneration
- Local saves, practice and assisted passage

Proposed or awaiting evidence

- Explicit Discard and saving warning
- Interview-backed persona validation
- Actual peer critique and fairness playtests

Supporting packet: 15 screens, 5 flows, 28 wireframes and exact AI evidence.